

Recap on Probability.

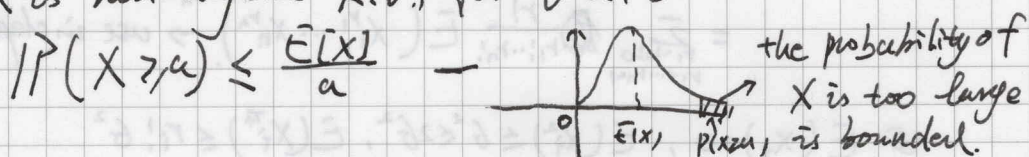
Concentration inequalities.

$\left| \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n X_i - \mathbb{E}\left[\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n X_i\right] \right|$ is small guaranteed with high probability.

Markov inequality.

X is non-negative R.V., for $\forall a > 0$.

$$\mathbb{P}(X \geq a) \leq \frac{\mathbb{E}[X]}{a}$$



If X is continuous R.V. with $f_X(x)$ as pdf

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}(X) &= \int_0^{+\infty} x f_X(x) dx = \int_0^a x f_X(x) dx + \int_a^{+\infty} x f_X(x) dx \\ &\geq \int_a^{+\infty} x f_X(x) dx \geq a \int_a^{+\infty} f_X(x) dx = a \mathbb{P}(X \geq a). \end{aligned}$$

Remarks:

+ : almost always works (X non-negative)

- : Bound is weak (not precise)

Power trick $\rightarrow$ sharper bound.

$$\mathbb{P}(X^r \geq a^r) \leq \frac{\mathbb{E}(X^r)}{a^r} \quad (\text{assume } r^{\text{th}} \text{ moment } \mathbb{E}(X^r) \text{ exist}).$$

Chebyshev's inequality.

X be R.V., for $\forall c > 0$

$$\mathbb{P}(|X - \mathbb{E}(X)| \geq c) \leq \frac{\text{Var}(X)}{c^2} \quad - \text{power trick of Markov}$$

$$\mathbb{P}(|X - \mathbb{E}(X)| \geq c) = \mathbb{P}((X - \mathbb{E}(X))^2 \geq c^2) \leq \frac{\mathbb{E}((X - \mathbb{E}(X))^2)}{c^2} = \frac{\text{Var}(X)}{c^2}.$$

Master tail bound.

Let $X = X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_n$, where $X_1, \dots, X_n$ are i.i.d. and

$\mathbb{E}(X_i) = 0$ $\mathbb{E}(X_i^2) \leq \sigma^2$ $|\mathbb{E}(X_i^s)| \leq \sigma^s$ for $s=3, 4, \dots, \frac{an}{\ln n}$
and $a \leq \sqrt{n} \sigma^2$.

$$\Rightarrow \text{prob}(|X| \geq a) \leq 3e^{-\frac{a^2}{12n\sigma^2}}$$

proof sketch:

①. choose r an even integer s.t. $0 < r \leq s$

$$P(|X| \geq a) = P(X^r \geq a^r) = \frac{E(X^r)}{a^r}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \textcircled{2} \quad E(X^r) &= E\left(\sum_{i=1}^n (x_i + x_2 + \dots + x_n)^r\right) = E\left(\sum_{\substack{r_1, r_2, \dots, r_n \geq 0 \\ r_1 + r_2 + \dots + r_n = r}} \frac{r!}{r_1! r_2! \dots r_n!} X_1^{r_1} \dots X_n^{r_n}\right) \\ &= \sum_{\substack{r_1, r_2, \dots, r_n \geq 0 \\ r_1 + r_2 + \dots + r_n = r}} \frac{r!}{r_1! r_2! \dots r_n!} E(X_1^{r_1} \dots X_n^{r_n}) \rightarrow \text{use independence} \end{aligned}$$

$$\textcircled{3} \quad E(X_i) = 0, \quad E(X_i^2) \leq \sigma^2 \leq 2\sigma^2, \quad E(X_i^{r_i}) \leq r_i! \sigma^2$$

$$\Rightarrow \sum_{\substack{r_1, r_2, \dots, r_n \geq 0 \\ r_1 + r_2 + \dots + r_n = r}} \frac{r!}{r_1! r_2! \dots r_n!} = \sum_{\substack{r_1, r_2, \dots, r_n \geq 0 \\ r_1 + r_2 + \dots + r_n = r}} 1 \Rightarrow t = \# \text{ of non zero } r_i$$

$$\Rightarrow 1 \leq t \leq r/2 \quad (r_i \text{ are at least } 2)$$

④ Enumerate $\sum$, to enumerate t $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{fixed } t, \binom{r}{t} \text{ ways to choose } r_i \\ \text{after fix, } \binom{r-t}{r_2+t-1} \text{ ways} \end{array} \right.$

* $\{r_i\}$ fixed, ~~first~~ ~~give~~ ~~even~~ like putting balls into bins,

first one r_1 has two, the rest $(r-2+t)$ will be put arbitrarily.

use insertion methods to count total ways.

$$\begin{aligned} \textcircled{5} \quad E(X^r) &\leq r! \sum_{t=1}^{r/2} \binom{n}{t} \binom{r-t-1}{t-1} \sigma^{2t}, \text{ use } \begin{cases} \binom{n}{t} \leq \frac{n^t}{t!} \left(\frac{n!}{t!(n-t)!} \right) \leq \frac{n \cdot n \cdot \dots \cdot n}{t!} \\ \binom{r-t-1}{t-1} \leq 2^{r-t-1} \binom{n}{t} \leq \binom{n}{t} \end{cases} \\ \Rightarrow E(X^r) &\leq r! \sum_{t=1}^{r/2} h(t), \text{ where } \frac{h(t)}{h(t-1)} \geq 2 \end{aligned}$$

$$\textcircled{6} \quad \text{Note } r \leq s \leq \lfloor \frac{a^2}{4n\sigma^2} \rfloor \Rightarrow r \leq s \leq \frac{nr}{2}$$

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{or } a \leq \sqrt{2n} \sigma^2 \\ \Rightarrow E(X^r) &\leq \left(\frac{2nr\sigma^2}{a^2} \right)^{r/2} = y(r) \end{aligned}$$

⑦ use the fact that $y(r) \downarrow$ as $r-1 \leq \frac{a^2}{4n\sigma^2}$.

choose r be the largest even integer. s.t. $r \leq \frac{a^2}{4n\sigma^2}$.

$$P(|X| \geq a) \leq (1/2)^{r/2} \leq e^{-r/2} \leq e e^{-\frac{a^2}{8n\sigma^2}} \leq 3e^{-\frac{a^2}{12n\sigma^2}}$$

$\rightarrow$ Full proof see Appendix.

Remarks: Master tail bound is a general probability tail bound.
for sum of iid R.V. that gives tighter concentration than
CLT. Tail bound for various distribution can be derived

Example: Chernoff Bounds. - case of iid Bernoulli.

$$Y_1, \dots, Y_n \text{ iid Bernoulli}(p) \rightarrow \begin{cases} 1, & p \\ 0, & 1-p \end{cases}$$

let $Y = Y_1 + \dots + Y_n$, then for $\forall c \in [0, 1]$

$$P\left[\left|\frac{Y}{n} - p\right| \geq \sqrt{2} \sqrt{p(1-p)}\right] \leq 3e^{-\frac{n(1-p)c^2}{6}}$$

Apply Master tail bound to $X_i = Y_i - p$, $E(X_i) = 0$

$$E(X_i^2) = E((Y_i - p)^2) = E(Y_i^2) + p^2 - 2pE(Y_i) = E(Y_i^2) - E^2(Y_i) = \text{Var}(Y_i)$$

$$|E(X_i^2)| = |p(1-p) + (1-p)(-p)^2| = p(1-p) = \text{Var}(Y_i).$$

Chernoff Bounds is obtained directly from master tail bound with
 $a = n\sqrt{2} \sqrt{p(1-p)}$

Concentration inequality using moment generating function.

Apply Markov to not to $|x|^r$, but to $e^{\lambda x}$.

$$P(X \geq t) = P(e^{\lambda X} \geq e^{\lambda t}) \leq \frac{E[e^{\lambda X}]}{e^{\lambda t}}, \quad \forall \lambda > 0.$$

$$\Rightarrow P(X \geq t) \leq \inf_{\lambda > 0} e^{-\lambda t} E[e^{\lambda X}], \text{ noticed } E[e^{\lambda X}] \text{ is moment generating function (MGF)}$$

(most lower bound)

Tail bound for Gaussian R.V.

$$X \sim N(0, \sigma^2), \quad E(e^{\lambda X}) = e^{\frac{1}{2}\sigma^2\lambda^2} \Rightarrow P(X \geq t) \leq \inf_{\lambda > 0} e^{-\lambda t} e^{\frac{1}{2}\sigma^2\lambda^2} = e^{-\frac{t^2}{2\sigma^2}}.$$

Hoeffding's Theorem.

let X_i be indep R.V. with $X_i \in [a_i, b_i]$ a.s., then $\forall t \geq 0$, $P\left(\sum X_i \geq t\right)$

$$P\left(\sum X_i - E(\sum X_i) \geq t\right) \leq 2e^{-\frac{t^2}{2\sum (b_i - a_i)^2}}$$

Hoeffding's lemma:

if X be a bounded R.V. s.t. $X \in [a, b]$ a.s., then

$$E(e^{\lambda(X - E(X))}) \leq e^{\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{b-a}{2}\right)^2\lambda^2}$$

proof of Hoeffding's theorem:

use ~~Chernoff~~ Markov tail bound for exponential

$$P(\sum_i X_i - E(X_i) \geq t) \leq e^{-\lambda t} E(e^{\lambda(\sum_i X_i - E(X_i))})$$

$$= e^{-\lambda t} \prod_i E(e^{\lambda(X_i - E(X_i))})$$

use Hoeffding's lemma, $E(e^{\lambda(X_i - E(X_i))}) \leq e^{\frac{\lambda^2}{2} \frac{(b_i - a_i)^2}{4}}$

$$\Rightarrow P(\sum_i X_i - E(X_i) \geq t) \leq e^{-\frac{2t^2}{\sum_i (b_i - a_i)^2}} \leftarrow \text{inf of}$$

Same thing can be shown for $-X_i$ as $P(\sum_i X_i - E(X_i) \leq -t)$.

$$\Rightarrow P(|\sum_i X_i - E(X_i)| \geq t) \leq 2e^{-\frac{2t^2}{\sum_i (b_i - a_i)^2}}.$$

χ^2 tail bound.

$z_i \stackrel{iid}{\sim} N(0,1)$ $X = \sum_i z_i^2 \sim \chi^2(n)$, $E(X) = n$, then.

$$P(|X - E(X)| \geq t) \leq 2 \exp[-c \min(t, \frac{t^2}{n})], \quad \forall t \geq 0$$

$$\text{proof: } P(X - E(X) \geq t) \leq e^{-\lambda t} e^{-n\lambda} E(e^{\lambda \sum_i z_i^2})$$

$$= e^{-\lambda t} e^{-n\lambda} \prod_i E(e^{\lambda z_i^2})$$

$E(e^{\lambda z_i^2})$ is mgf of $\chi^2(1) = (1-2\lambda)^{-1/2}$, $\lambda \in (0, 1/2)$.

$$\Rightarrow P(X - E(X) \geq t) \leq e^{-\lambda t} e^{-n\lambda} (1-2\lambda)^{-n/2}$$

$$= e^{-\lambda t} \left(\frac{e^{-\lambda(1-2\lambda)^{-1/2}}}{1-2\lambda} \right)^n \leq e^{-\lambda t + 2n\lambda^2}, \quad \forall \lambda \in (0, 1/4)$$

$\frac{e^{-\lambda(1-2\lambda)^{-1/2}}}{1-2\lambda}$ increase as $\lambda \rightarrow 1/2$.
 $e^{2\lambda^2} > \frac{1}{e^{\lambda(1-2\lambda)^{-1/2}}}, \lambda \in (0, 1/4)$

$$\min_{\lambda \in (0, 1/4)} e^{-\lambda t + 2n\lambda^2} = \exp(-c \min(t, \frac{t^2}{n}))$$

$$\Rightarrow P(X - E(X) \geq t) \leq \exp(-c \min(t, \frac{t^2}{n}))$$

$$P(X - n \leq -t) = P(-(X - n) \geq t) \leq e^{-\lambda t} e^{n\lambda} E(e^{-\lambda X}) = e^{-\lambda t} e^{n\lambda} (1+2\lambda)^{-n/2}$$

$$\leq e^{-\lambda t} e^{n\lambda^2} \quad \forall \lambda > 0$$

$$P(X - n \leq -t) \leq e^{-\frac{t^2}{4n}}$$

$$\Rightarrow P(|X - E(X)| \geq t) \leq 2 \exp(-c \min(t, \frac{t^2}{n}))$$